

**Weak Two-bids**

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

**Preemptive Bids**

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



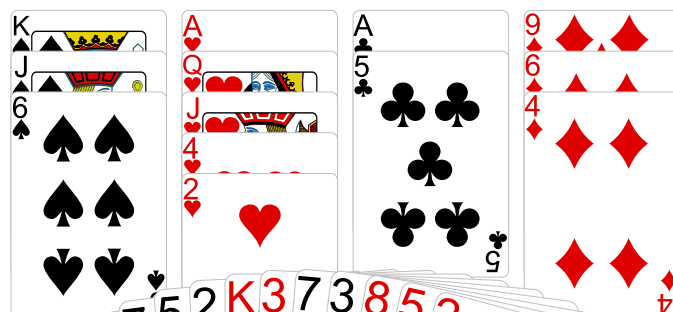
### Count Sure Winners

| ♠ | ♥ | ♦ | ♣ | Total |
|---|---|---|---|-------|
|   |   |   |   |       |

### Decide How to Develop Winners

| Promotion | Length | Finesse | End Play |
|-----------|--------|---------|----------|
|           |        |         |          |

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



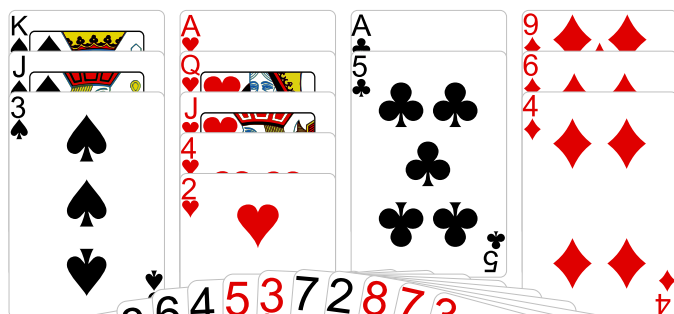
### Count Fast and Slow Losers

| ♠ | ♥ | ♦ | ♣ | Total |
|---|---|---|---|-------|
|   |   |   |   |       |

### Decide How to Reduce Losers

| Ruffs | Finesse | Pitch | Length |
|-------|---------|-------|--------|
|       |         |       |        |

Deal 3 Ctr: 3♠ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



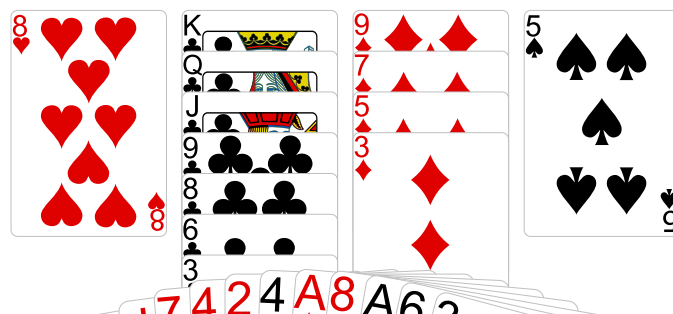
### Count Fast and Slow Losers

| ♠ | ♥ | ♦ | ♣ | Total |
|---|---|---|---|-------|
|   |   |   |   |       |

### Decide How to Reduce Losers

| Ruffs | Finesse | Pitch | Length |
|-------|---------|-------|--------|
|       |         |       |        |

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



### Count Fast and Slow Losers

| ♠ | ♥ | ♦ | ♣ | Total |
|---|---|---|---|-------|
|   |   |   |   |       |

### Decide How to Reduce Losers

| Ruffs | Finesse | Pitch | Length |
|-------|---------|-------|--------|
|       |         |       |        |

Board: 1  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 6NT  
Declarer: North

Board: 2  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 4♠  
Declarer: East

Board: 3  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 3♠  
Declarer: South

Board: 4  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 4♥  
Declarer: West

Board: 5  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 4♥  
Declarer: North

Board: 6  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: East

**Deal 1**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ T 8 7 6 3 2  
♥ J 4 2  
♦ T  
♣ Q 7 3

21  
3 7  
9

♠ K Q J  
♥ A K 7  
♦ J 6 3  
♣ A K 4 2



♠ 5 4  
♥ 8 6 3  
♦ A K Q 9 7 4  
♣ 8 5

♠ A 9  
♥ Q T 9 5  
♦ 8 5 2  
♣ J T 9 6

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 2♦    |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| Pass         | 6NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6NT by North |       |      |       |

A K Q x x x NORTH has an easy 6NT bid.

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The 2NT response to a Weak Two opening is a wonderful tool. You can learn a lot about

partner's hand and you are absolutely certain that it will not be passed out.

In this Deal NORTH has a huge hand and SOUTH opens 2

♦

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There are a lot of approaches NORTH might try, but the simplest is to start with 2NT.

When SOUTH shows

**Deal 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6  
♥ A Q J 4 2  
♦ 9 6 4  
♣ A 5

6  
15 9  
10

♠ T 8 3  
♥ 8 5  
♦ K J 3  
♣ Q 9 8 6 4



♠ 4  
♥ T 9 7 6  
♦ A Q T 7  
♣ K J T 2

♠ A Q 9 7 5 2  
♥ K 3  
♦ 8 5 2  
♣ 7 3

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WEST is unsure whether to bid game or not.  
So she temporizes with 2NT.

EAST shows an above average hand plus a high card in



s.

WEST is no longer unsure, so she bids 4♠.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
|            |       | 2♠   | Pass  |
| 2NT        | Pass  | 3♥   | Pass  |
| 4♠         |       |      |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by East |       |      |       |

**Deal 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 5 2

♥ K

♦ Q 2

♣ K J T 9 8 4 3

15

9 10

6

♠ K J 3

♥ A Q J 4 2

♦ 9 6 4

♣ A 5



♠ A Q 9 8 6 4

♥ 5 3

♦ 8 7 3

♣ 7 2

♠ T

♥ T 9 8 7 6

♦ A K J T 5

♣ Q 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

2♠

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

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NORTH is unsure whether to bid game or not,  
so he bids 2NT to get more information about

SOUTH's hand.

SOUTH's 3♠ is discouraging, a hand below  
average in strength and no outside high card.

NORTH passes and hopes for the best.

**Deal 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 6 3  
♥ A K Q J 7 4 2  
♦ A 8  
♣ 4

6  
18 6  
10

♠ T 9 4 2  
♥ T 6 5  
♦ Q 6 4 2  
♣ A 2



♠ K Q J 8 7  
♥ 9 3  
♦ K J T  
♣ T 7 5

♠ 5  
♥ 8  
♦ 9 7 5 3  
♣ K Q J 9 8 6 3

West

North

East  
3♣

South  
Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

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WEST has no way to tell whether EAST can provide one winner or not.

So she takes the bold approach and bids 4

♥

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If the opening lead is a ♠ or a

♦

then WEST

will probably make the game. Otherwise she will likely go down one.

**Deal 5**

South Deals  
N-S Vul

♠ A 8 6 5  
♥ T 4  
♦ 9 3  
♣ A K 7 5 2

14  
11 7  
8

♠ K 3  
♥ A J 9 6 3  
♦ A Q 7  
♣ 8 6 4



♠ Q J T 7 4 2  
♥ K Q 7 2  
♦ 5 2  
♣ 9

♠ 9  
♥ 8 5  
♦ K J T 8 6 4  
♣ Q J T 3

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass        | 1♥    | Pass | Pass  |
| Pass        | 4♥    |      | 3♥    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by North |       |      |       |

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Most good players have an extra restriction in their Weak Two-bid guidelines - they won't

open with a Weak Two-bid when they hold an outside 4-card Major, even if the hand qualifies

otherwise. This Deal shows why.

If SOUTH opened with 2♠, NORTH might well pass and a



game

would be missed.

**Deal 6**

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 2  
♥ 7 4 2  
♦ A J T 8 3 2  
♣ K 7

8  
8 16  
8

♠ K J 8  
♥ K 6 5 3  
♦ 9 6  
♣ J 9 8 6



♠ T 9 7 5 4  
♥ Q 9 8  
♦ Q  
♣ A 5 3 2

♠ A Q 3  
♥ A J T  
♦ K 7 5 4  
♣ Q T 4

West

2♦

3♣

All Pass

3NT by East

North

Pass

Pass

East

2NT

3NT

South

Pass

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EAST responds 2NT, asking for more information.

When WEST shows a decent hand with a high  
♣ EAST should bid 3NT.